KEIKO MARIE A. NEPACENA

HR Head | People & Culture Leader | HR Systems & Automation

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HR Head and People & Culture leader with 5+ years of progressive HR experience, currently heading the full employee lifecycle for a 250+ employee travel company. Combines global HR shared-services discipline from Accenture and Marsh McLennan (Mercer) with hands-on HR technology skills: designed and built the company's in-house HRIS and payroll system (PaySync PH) and an AI-powered recruitment portal (Gladex Careers). Strong in talent acquisition, employee relations, performance management, compensation and benefits, policy development, and Philippine labor (DOLE) and BIR compliance. Known for confidential, accurate handling of employee data and for turning manual HR processes into simple, automated systems.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- **Built an in-house HRIS & payroll system.** PaySync PH is used for 255 employees and 39 approving managers, replacing manual spreadsheets for attendance, scheduling, approvals and payroll compliance.
- **Launched AI-powered recruitment.** Gladex Careers gives candidates a 24/7 AI assistant (GIA), on-page CV applications and an instant applicant ID.
- **Leads People & Culture end to end.** Strategic HR partner to the CEO for a 250+ employee organization, owning policy, performance, rewards and compliance, plus culture and CSR programs such as a company trip to Hong Kong and a pediatric cancer outreach.
- **Applies AI to HR operations.** Completed JTL Growth's AI Staff Training (2026) and built a working AI employee.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- HR Strategy & Workforce Planning
- Talent Acquisition & Recruitment
- Employee & Labor Relations
- Performance Management
- Compensation, Benefits & Pre-Payroll
- HR Policy & DOLE / BIR Compliance
- HRIS Implementation & HR Technology
- HR Process Automation & AI in HR
- Learning & Development
- Onboarding & Offboarding
- Records & 201 File Management
- Data Privacy (RA 10173)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

HR Head, People and Culture
Jan 2026 – Present

Gladex Travel and Tours Corporation, Manila

- Head the entire People and Culture function for 250+ employees, covering talent acquisition, onboarding, employee relations, performance management, compensation and benefits, training and offboarding.
- Serve as strategic HR partner to the CEO and management team on workforce planning, organizational structure and talent development.
- Designed and built PaySync PH, the company's in-house HRIS and payroll system: biometric attendance import (ZKBioTime / Yunatt), team scheduling, e-signed leave, overtime, offset and schedule-change approvals, employee self-service and BIR 1601-C / 0619-E computations.
- Launched Gladex Careers, an AI-powered recruitment portal with an AI assistant (GIA) and on-page CV applications, compliant with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (RA 10173).
- Led employee engagement and CSR programs: the Company Hong Kong Trip 2026 (team building and employer-branding content) and the Bahay Aruga Outreach Program for pediatric cancer patients.
- Develop and implement company-wide HR policies, procedures and employee handbook provisions aligned with business goals and Philippine labor regulations.
- Own the performance management cycle end to end: goal-setting, appraisals and career development plans across all departments.
- Oversee HRIS data integrity, 201 files and employment documentation, including government-mandated compliance requirements.

HR and Admin Officer
May 2025 – Nov 2025

Medley Philippines Inc.

- Maintained accurate HR databases and employee records and provided onboarding support for smooth HR service delivery.
- Drafted HR policies and documents in compliance with labor regulations; first point of contact for employee queries.

HR Management Analyst
Feb 2024 – Mar 2025

Best Options Incorporated

- Performed end-to-end HR processes covering employee records, employee relations, pre-payroll data and clearance.

- Partnered with managers on performance management plans: goal setting, appraisals and career development.
- Designed and delivered training programs, identifying needs through job analysis and performance reviews.
- Resolved employee concerns and grievances as point of contact, fostering a positive work environment.

HRSS Operations Associate
Sep 2023 – Dec 2023

Marsh McLennan (Mercer)

- Developed and localized HR guidelines and policies in line with current legislation and modern HR best practices.

HR Service Delivery Associate
May 2021 – Sep 2023

Accenture Inc.

- Managed the employee-data record lifecycle from creation to disposal, safeguarding the integrity of physical and electronic records.
- Performed recruitment sourcing and processing, liaising with hiring managers to fill approved positions.
- Supported compensation and rewards programs, including calamity benefits, designed to attract, engage and retain talent.
- Executed exit and employee-relations processes with HR policy and internal-control compliance.

Recruitment Assistant
Jan 2021 – May 2021

ABBA Personnel Services Inc.

- Handled end-to-end recruitment, sourcing and pre-qualifying candidates primarily through online channels.

Barista
Jun 2018 – Nov 2020

Starbucks Philippines Inc.

- Built customer-service, teamwork and operational discipline in a high-volume retail environment while completing a psychology degree.

FEATURED PROJECTS

PaySync PH: HRIS & Payroll System
2026

In-house HR platform built to replace manual spreadsheets, used for 255 employees and 39 approving managers.

- Live workforce dashboard: on-time, late, absent, on-leave, overbreak and pending-overtime counts in PH time.
- Biometric attendance import, WFH attendance, team scheduling with approved-schedule links and change history.

Gladex Careers: AI-Powered Recruitment Site
2026

Public careers portal that lets candidates explore roles, ask an AI assistant and apply in minutes. gdxcareers.base44.app

- GIA (Gladex Intelligent Assistant), an AI chatbot answering candidate questions 24/7.
- Three-step application with CV upload (PDF, DOC, DOCX) and an instant applicant ID.

PEOPLE & CULTURE INITIATIVES

Company Hong Kong Trip 2026 | *Employee Engagement & Team Building*
Aug 2026

- Organized a company trip to Hong Kong (Aug 6-10, 2026) to strengthen team camaraderie and create shared experiences beyond the workplace.
- Partnered with an external content creator to capture the trip, supporting employer branding through authentic storytelling.

Bahay Aruga Outreach Program 2026 | *Corporate Social Responsibility*
Aug 2026

- Led a company outreach (Aug 26, 2026) at Bahay Aruga, a free halfway house for pediatric cancer patients in Paco, Manila.
- Encouraged employee volunteerism and connected company values with meaningful community involvement.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Psychology
2020

Rizal Technological University

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- **AI Staff Training: Certificate of Completion**, JTL Growth (Oct 2026). Credential ID JTL-GLX-2610-03
- **Basic Occupational Safety & Health Training for Safety Officer 2** (2026)
- **Occupational Safety: First Aider**, Philippine Red Cross (2024)
- **Occupational First Aid and BLS CPR/AED Training**, OFAT (2024)
- **Professional training,** Accenture (2023): Driving Analytics & Taking Actions; Writing with Precision; Critical Thinking; Presentation Dynamics; Speak Up!

HR SYSTEMS & TOOLS

Workday • ServiceNow • ADP (REAMS) • Aconso • HRIS: ICES • ZKBioTime / Yunatt biometrics • Base44 (AI app builder) • AI assistants & chatbots • Payroll Systems • Microsoft Excel & Office